Until the Final Act

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Until the Final Act

by Lunaeryi

Summary

> Year 4931 of the Light Calendar, Month of Balance, Nikador—the Strife Titan, Lance of Fury—fell. Mydeimos, king of Kremnos, triumphed over the trial, and the new god was born.
>
> On the following day, the Kremnoan dynasty, which had lasted for a thousand years, came to an end.

Or, a slightly different take on Mydei and Phainon's last conversation.

Notes

> Oh god. I don't know what to say. I plopped my ass down at 7 and now it's nearly 11 and I'm trying not to cry (I'm not even done with the quest I just have too much feels in my heart rn)
>
> Help me omg.

See the end of the work for more notes

Phainon walked beside Mydei through the streets of Okhema, matching his pace, though part of him wished Mydei would slow down. There was no ceremony, no grand farewell—just the two of them walking through a city that had already begun to fade from Mydei's grasp. The banners above swayed in the wind, their colors muted in the evening light, as if even Okhema knew this was a moment that demanded reverence.

Phainon watched him, memorizing the set of his shoulders, the measured way he walked, as if each step was already carrying him somewhere beyond this world.

"Moving awfully fast, aren't you?" Phainon mused, breaking the silence. "Afraid you'll change your mind?"

Mydei didn't look at him. "No."

A simple answer. Unshaken. Unwavering.

Phainon sighed, shaking his head. "You always were the stubborn one."

Mydei continued forward, as if Phainon hadn't spoken. As if there was nothing left to say.

And perhaps there wasn't.

Yet Phainon found himself speaking anyway, his words slipping into their usual cadence of teasing ease. "You know, for all the trouble we went through, I thought we'd have at least one victory that didn't feel like a funeral. I should've known better."

Mydei finally glanced at him. "Do you truly feel as carefree as you seem?"

Phainon forced a smirk. "You sound just like Aglaea." He chuckled, but the sound was hollow. "She used to see through my carefully crafted illusions, too."

Mydei did not smile. "Then stop pretending."

Phainon exhaled sharply through his nose. “You never let me have my fun, do you?”

“There is nothing fun about this.”

He said it so simply, so matter-of-factly, that Phainon felt something twist in his chest.

The silence stretched between them, filled only by the distant rustling of banners, the soft scuff of boots against stone.

Then, at last, Mydei spoke again. “I have a final favor to ask.”

Phainon hummed, tilting his head. “Ah, this is where you make me promise something ridiculous, isn’t it?”

“Look after the Kremnoan warriors in my absence.”

The humor drained from Phainon’s expression.

“They will face challenges while assimilating into Okhema,” Mydei continued, his voice steady. “It is my sole regret that I cannot stand by them during this time.”

His sole regret.

Not the war. Not the sacrifices.

Not even leaving Phainon behind.

Phainon let out a slow breath, rubbing the back of his neck. “Do not worry,” he said, softer this time. “Leave it to me.”

Mydei gave him a small nod of thanks.

Phainon forced a smirk, trying to lighten the weight pressing against his ribs. “And while I’m at it, I think I’ll finally uncover the truth—does the Kremnoan language really have so few words, or are you all just hoarding them for dramatic effect?”

A faint huff of amusement escaped Mydei. “The Kremnoan philosophy can never be encapsulated in a mere dictionary.”

Phainon laughed under his breath. He had spent years translating Mydei’s silences, his glances, the careful way he spoke. And now, standing at the edge of farewell, he realized there were still things left unsaid.

Things that would never be spoken.

And Mydei—perhaps knowing this, perhaps sensing the unspoken weight between them—spoke again.

“If there’s a chance in the next life,” Mydei said, “you should come visit my library.”

Phainon stilled.

For a moment, the words did not register. But then he turned, looking at Mydei fully, searching his face for—what? A joke? A glimmer of hesitation?

He found none.

The request was light, said without urgency. And yet, something in Mydei’s voice made it feel like a promise.

Phainon chuckled, but the sound was quieter this time. “Hmph. Always thinking ahead, aren’t you?”

Mydei didn’t respond, but he didn’t need to.

The end was here.

Phainon had known it was coming, had accepted it long before this walk through the city. And yet, as Mydei turned away, as he took those final steps toward the fate he had chosen, something in Phainon rebelled.

He wanted to reach out. To grab Mydei by the wrist, to pull him back, to say something reckless and selfish and true.

But he didn’t.

Instead, he watched.

Watched as Mydei walked forward, unwavering, the wind stirring the hem of his cloak, his silhouette carved against the distant horizon.

Watched until the figure he had fought beside, laughed with, bled for, and—

He exhaled.

It didn’t matter.

He had made his peace.

Phainon turned on his heel, tilting his head up toward the sky.

The banners still rustled. The city still stood.

And behind him, somewhere beyond the veil of sight, Mydei stepped into eternity.

Phainon did not call him back.

But he whispered, just under his breath—so soft, so quiet, it might have been the wind carrying the words away.

“Don’t die too easily.”

End Notes

This was pretty short since I just needed to get my thoughts out😭😭 The angst here was insane though, especially that one scene where Mydei sits on his throne and says I’m back home mom??

Like I was thirsting over that, but now that I really get the context of it, how Mydei is forever forced into his role and all that philosophical thing abt it I don’t want to write abt, I feel so sad😭😭

I would finish the quest rn but I got school next morning, so tomorrow it is.

(PS THAT ONE SCENE WITH MYDEI TELLING PHAINON HIS WEAKNESS SO HE KILLS HIM IF HE GOES INSANE LIKE NIKADOR AND HIS TALK WITH AGLAEA ABT WHAT HE HEARD???? MYDEI WILL LIVEEEE)

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